

Gotham Consult
ACCRA · GHANA

OCTOBER 2026 EDITION

INVESTOR COUNTRY GUIDE

# Ghana Investment Report *2026*

The economy and its five key sectors: the figures, the rules, the opportunities and the risks, with an outlook to 2028. Every number linked to its official source and re-checked every week.

| 61 | 5 | 3 | 7 Oct 2026 |
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PREPARED BY

**Uffe Carlson**
Partner, Gotham Consult
uffe.carlson@gmail.com
+233 55 239 5548 · WhatsApp

**Joy Preston**
Managing Partner, Gotham Consult
joy@gothamconsult.com
+233 55 041 6627 · WhatsApp

ECONOMY SNAPSHOT

# Ghana in eight numbers

Growth, prices, rates and reserves. Figures marked Live refresh automatically from the Bank of Ghana and the Ghana Statistical Service.

Real GDP growth Live
**6 %**
2026Q2 · source

Inflation Live
**5 %**
2026M08 · source

Bank of Ghana policy rate Live
**14 %**
August 2026 · source

Cedi per US dollar
**11.55 GHS**
September 2026 · source

Gross international reserves
**12.0 USD bn**
22 September 2026 · source

Merchandise exports, year to date Live
**22.44 USD bn**
August 2026 · source

Public debt
**45.9 % of GDP**
End-July 2026 · source

Foreign direct investment
**2.61 USD bn**
2025, 253 projects · source

## Where export earnings come from

January–August 2026, USD billion




- Gold **USD 14.86bn**
- Cocoa **USD 2.76bn**
- Crude oil **USD 2.42bn**
- Other **USD 2.4bn**

Source: Bank of Ghana, Summary of Economic and Financial Data (September 2026)

## What is growing fastest

Real growth, Q2 2026, % year on year

| | |
|---|---|
| ICT | **30.9%** |
| Oil and gas | **21.4%** |
| Services | **8%** |
| Manufacturing | **6.6%** |
| **Whole economy** | **6%** |
| Construction | **4.4%** |
| Industry | **4.3%** |
| Agriculture | **3.9%** |

Fishing contracted 24.7%. Source: Ghana Statistical Service, Q2 2026 GDP (reported by MyJoyOnline and GNA)

## Who is investing

New projects registered in 2025, by source country

| | |
|---|---|
| China | **70** |
| India | **22** |
| Nigeria | **10** |
| UAE | **9** |
| United Kingdom | **8** |

Source: GIPC, 2025 investment report (reported by Citi Newsroom)


Uffe Carlson, uffe.carlson@gmail.com, +233 55 239 5548 · Joy Preston, joy@gothamconsult.com, +233 55 041 6627

GOTHAM VIEW · AS OF 7 OCTOBER 2026

# Outlook 2026–2028: three scenarios

Our view of where Ghana's economy is heading, in three scenarios. Each starts from the official forecasts of the IMF, the World Bank, the Bank of Ghana and the Ministry of Finance, and adds our reading of the drivers that matter most: gold, cocoa, oil, the cedi and public finances.

### BASE CASE

**55%** likely

Growth stays around 5% as the gold boom cools but ICT, services and oil keep expanding. Inflation drifts back into the Bank of Ghana's 8% ± 2 band as the cedi weakens gradually, so rate cuts are slow. The February 2027 domestic bond repayments are met from the sinking fund.

- Gold about US$4,700/oz in 2026 and US$4,300 in 2027 (World Bank)
- Cocoa about US$3.80/kg in 2026 and US$4.20 in 2027 (World Bank); a smaller 2026/27 crop
- Oil output around 95,000 barrels a day in 2026, rising with new Jubilee wells from 2027
- Primary surplus of 1.5% of GDP in 2026 and 0.5% from 2027, as legislated

### UPSIDE

**20%** likely

Gold stays above US$4,500 into 2027, new Jubilee wells lift oil output above 100,000 barrels a day and the cocoa crop recovers. Reserves rise towards six months of imports, the cedi is broadly stable and the Bank of Ghana can cut rates further.

- Gold above US$4,500/oz through 2027
- Jubilee above 90,000 barrels a day from 2027
- Cocoa output recovers towards 750,000 tonnes
- Fiscal discipline holds through the 2028 election year

### DOWNSIDE

**25%** likely

Gold falls back towards US$3,800, the cocoa crop disappoints and election-cycle spending returns. With large domestic bond repayments in 2027–2028, the cedi weakens faster, inflation moves above the target band and the Bank of Ghana has to raise rates again.

- Gold below US$3,800/oz by 2027
- Cocoa crop near or below 650,000 tonnes
- Energy-sector arrears rise again
- Fiscal slippage ahead of the December 2028 election

## Our forecasts at a glance

| INDICATOR | 2026 | 2027 | 2028 |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Real GDP growth** (%) | **5.5**<br>5.0–6.0 | **5.0**<br>3.5–6.0 | **5.0**<br>3.5–6.0 |
| **Inflation, end of year** (%) | **7.0**<br>6.0–9.0 | **8.5**<br>7.0–13.0 | **9.0**<br>7.5–14.0 |
| **Bank of Ghana policy rate, end of year** (%) | **14.0**<br>13.0–14.0 | **13.0**<br>11.0–17.0 | **13.0**<br>10.5–18.0 |
| **Cedi per US dollar, end of year** (GHS) | **12.2**<br>11.8–12.8 | **13.4**<br>12.5–15.5 | **14.8**<br>13.5–18.0 |
| **Gross reserves, months of imports** (months) | **4.5**<br>4.0–4.8 | **4.8**<br>3.5–5.5 | **5.0**<br>3.0–6.0 |

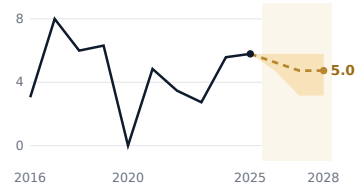
Bold: base case. Small: range from downside to upside scenario.

## History and outlook

— Actual  - - Base case  Upside–downside range

### Real GDP growth

% · latest: H1 2026: 6.2%




H1 2026 grew 6.2%; we expect a slower second half as the oil boost fades. Official forecasts (4.8% for 2026) look cautious; Fitch Solutions expects 5.7%.

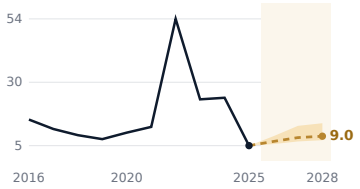
**Official forecasts we start from**

- IMF: 4.8 / 4.9 / 5.0% (2026/27/28) source
- World Bank: 4.8 / 4.9 / 5.0% source
- Ministry of Finance: at least 4.8% in 2026 source
- Fitch Solutions/BMI: Fitch Solutions: 5.7% in 2026 source

History: IMF World Economic Outlook (Ghana Statistical Service data)

### Inflation, end of year

% · latest: August 2026: 5.0%




Inflation is below the 8% ± 2 target band now; the Bank of Ghana expects it to move up into the band as the weaker cedi feeds through.

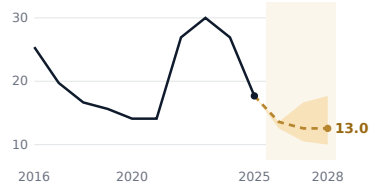
**Official forecasts we start from**

- IMF: IMF: 8.0% at end of each year source
- Bank of Ghana: Bank of Ghana target: 8% ± 2 source
- Ministry of Finance: Budget target: 8.0% at end-2026 source
- Fitch Solutions/BMI: Fitch Solutions: 9.0% end-2026, 13.2% end-2027 source

History: Bank of Ghana, Summary of Economic and Financial Data

### Bank of Ghana policy rate, end of year

% · latest: Since March 2026: 14.0%




With inflation near 5% the real policy rate is about 9%, very high; but rising inflation and a weaker cedi argue for holding in November and cutting slowly.

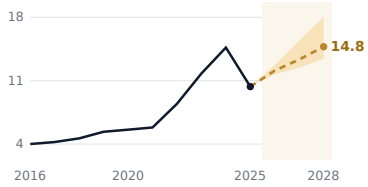
**Official forecasts we start from**

- Bank of Ghana: held at 14.0% on 24 September 2026 source
- Bank of Ghana: next decision 16–18 November 2026 source

History: Bank of Ghana, Summary of Economic and Financial Data

### Cedi per US dollar, end of year

GHS · latest: September 2026: 11.55




The cedi has lost 9.5% this year after a 40.7% gain in 2025. Our base case assumes about 10% a year of depreciation from 2027, more in the 2028 election year.

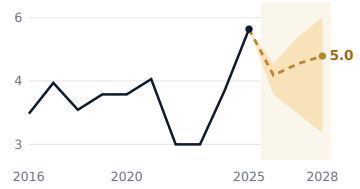
**Official forecasts we start from**

- Databank Research: Databank: GH¢12.20 at end-2026 source
- Bank of Ghana data: down 9.5% in January–September 2026 source

History: Bank of Ghana, Summary of Economic and Financial Data

### Gross reserves, months of imports

months · latest: 22 September 2026: 4.5




Reserves fell from US$14.2bn in March to US$11.1bn in August; a lower gold price would slow the rebuild the IMF expects.

**Official forecasts we start from**

- IMF: IMF: 4.5 / 5.0 / 5.5 months source
- Bank of Ghana: US$12.0bn, 4.5 months on 22 September 2026 source

History: Bank of Ghana, Summary of Economic and Financial Data

## What it means by sector

| SECTOR | BASE CASE | UPSIDE | DOWNSIDE |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Gold and mining** | Margins stay strong even with the sliding royalty; watch the Minerals and Mining Act amendments on stability agreements. | Record export earnings; strongest case for new large-scale projects and local refining. | A lower gold price and the higher royalty bands squeeze new projects; small-scale output falls first. |

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Oil, gas and power** | New Jubilee wells support output; power offtaker arrears remain the key risk for IPPs. | Output back above 100,000 barrels a day; more room to clear energy arrears. | Arrears build up again; prefer commercial and industrial solar with private offtakers. |
| **Cocoa and agribusiness** | Lower world cocoa prices cut export earnings; the 50% local-processing mandate supports grinders. | Crop recovery plus processing incentives make 2027 a good entry point for processors. | A small crop and EU deforestation rules hit volumes; traceability becomes a must-have. |
| **ICT and fintech** | Still the fastest-growing sector; a weaker cedi raises the cost of imported equipment. | Strong demand for payments, data centres and software services. | Growth slows but stays positive; cedi revenue loses value in dollars. |
| **Real estate and construction** | High interest rates keep mortgages scarce; demand for mid-market housing remains. | Rate cuts open up mortgage finance and construction activity. | Higher rates and a weaker cedi raise building costs and stall projects. |
| **Exporters and importers** | A gradually weaker cedi favours exporters with costs in cedis. | A stable cedi helps importers and companies with dollar debt. | Dollar earners win; importers and dollar borrowers should hedge. |

## Events that could move the forecast

**16–18 Nov 2026**
Bank of Ghana policy-rate decision

**Early Nov 2026**
2027 Budget Statement

**Feb 2027**
GH¢30bn of restructured domestic bonds fall due

**Mar 2027**
First IMF review under the new Policy Coordination Instrument

**2027–2028**
Domestic bond repayments of GH¢58bn and GH¢53bn

**Dec 2028**
General election

## Scorecard

We publish how our base-case forecasts compare with the outcomes, every quarter.

| 2026 FORECAST | BASE CASE | OUTCOME |
|---|---|---|
| **Real GDP growth** | 5.5 % | *Due Dec 2026* |
| **Inflation, end of year** | 7.0 % | *Due Jan 2027* |
| **Bank of Ghana policy rate, end of year** | 14.0 % | *Due Jan 2027* |
| **Cedi per US dollar, end of year** | 12.2 GHS | *Due Jan 2027* |
| **Gross reserves, months of imports** | 4.5 months | *Due Jan 2027* |

Scenarios start from the latest official projections and add our judgement on the drivers listed. They are estimates from public data, not a statistical model, and not investment advice. We review them every quarter and after major data releases, and keep a public scorecard of our forecasts against the outcomes.


Uffe Carlson, uffe.carlson@gmail.com, +233 55 239 5548 · Joy Preston, joy@gothamconsult.com, +233 55 041 6627



CHAPTER 1

# Economy and investment climate

*Ghana's real GDP grew 6.0% in Q2 2026 (6.2% in H1) with inflation at 5.0% and the Bank of Ghana policy rate held at 14.0%, as the country exited its US$3bn IMF programme in July 2026.*

Ghana has moved from crisis recovery to post-programme consolidation: the IMF Board completed the final ECF review on 27 July 2026 and Ghana now operates under a 36-month non-financing Policy Coordination Instrument. Growth remains solid (6.0% in Q2 2026, led by services and ICT at +30.9%), inflation is low at 5.0% (August 2026), public debt is 45.9% of GDP and gross reserves stood at US$12.0bn (4.5 months of imports) on 22 September 2026. The main macro watch-points are a cedi that has weakened 9.5% year-to-date to GHS 11.55/USD (September 2026), a slower IMF growth projection of 4.9% for 2026, ratings still in single-B territory, and February 2027 domestic debt repayments. For investors, the new GIPA Act 2026 (Act 1173) removes blanket minimum capital for wholly foreign-owned firms and joint ventures, and the 2027 Budget is expected in the first week of November 2026.

## Key figures

**Real GDP growth**

**6.0** % y/y

Q2 2026 (H1 2026: 6.2%)

Reported MyJoyOnline reporting Ghana Statistical Service Q2 2026 GDP release (10 Sep 2026)

**Nominal GDP**

**118.29** US$ billion

2025 (IMF estimate, shown by GIPA, updated 6 Oct 2026)

Official Ghana Investment Promotion Authority homepage indicators

**Headline CPI inflation**

**5.0** % y/y

August 2026

Official Ghana Statistical Service – Inflation highlights

**Bank of Ghana Monetary Policy Rate**

**14.0** %

Held at 132nd MPC, 23–24 Sep 2026

Official Bank of Ghana MPC Press Release, September 2026

**Cedi exchange rate (interbank)**

**11.55** GHS per USD

9.5% depreciation year-to-date

September 2026 (Aug 2026: 11.25; Dec 2025: 10.45)

Official Bank of Ghana Summary of Economic and Financial Data, September 2026

**Gross international reserves**

**12.0** US$ billion

4.5 months of import cover

22 September 2026

Official Bank of Ghana MPC Press Release, September 2026

**Public debt**

**45.9** % of GDP

End-July 2026 (end-2025: 44.7%)

Official Bank of Ghana MPC Press Release, September 2026

**Gold export receipts**

**14.86** US$ billion

cocoa 2.76; crude oil 2.42

January–August 2026 cumulative

Official Bank of Ghana Summary of Economic and Financial Data, September 2026

**FDI inflows (GIPC-recorded)**

**2.61** US$ billion

253 projects; China leads by count with 70

Calendar year 2025 (2024: US$617.61m)

Reported Graphic Online reporting GIPC 2025 investment report (May 2026)

**Fitch sovereign rating**

**B**

upgraded from B-, outlook positive

8 May 2026

Reported News Ghana reporting Fitch Ratings action

**S&P sovereign rating**

**B-/B**

affirmed, outlook stable

28 September 2026

Reported Modern Ghana reporting S&P Global Ratings action

**Moody's sovereign rating**

**Caa1**

affirmed, outlook raised to positive

April 2026

Reported Citi Newsroom reporting Moody's Ratings action

### Rules that matter

- GIPA Act 2026 (Act 1173), assented 15 July 2026, converts GIPC into the Ghana Investment Promotion Authority, removes blanket minimum capital requirements for wholly foreign-owned enterprises and joint ventures, introduces a statutory Investor Grievance Mechanism, a One-Stop-Shop and annual registration renewal. source
- Trading enterprises with non-citizen participation still require a minimum of US$500,000 in cash equity (down from US$1m), and at least 75% of the workforce must be skilled Ghanaians; activities reserved for Ghanaians are retained. source
- Profit repatriation: Act 1173 protects the free transfer of capital, profits and dividends and retains protection against unlawful expropriation (law-firm summary; check the Act text before relying on specific clauses). source
- Free zones: a 10-year corporate income tax holiday (the rate after the holiday has changed over time; confirm it with GFZA and GRA); no withholding tax on dividends; duty-free imports for production; at least 70% of output must be exported (up to 30% may be sold locally); no restrictions on repatriation of dividends or net profit. source
- VAT reform effective 1 January 2026: effective VAT rate 20% (15% VAT + 2.5% NHIL + 2.5% GETFund), registration threshold for goods traders raised from GH₵200,000 to GH₵750,000, VAT Flat Rate Scheme and COVID-19 Health Recovery Levy abolished. source
- 24-Hour Economy incentives are performance-based (tied to jobs, investment and productivity), carry sunset clauses of typically four to five years, and beneficiaries will be listed on a public register; investors above US$50m can negotiate customised packages. source

### Opportunities

- Digital economy momentum: ICT was the fastest-growing activity in Q2 2026 at +30.9%, and investment (gross capital formation) rose 53.0%, supporting demand for data, connectivity and software services. source
- Cheaper local credit: the average lending rate fell to 15.9% from 24.2% a year earlier, the 91-day T-bill to 5.4%, and private-sector credit growth rebounded to 35.5% in August 2026. source
- 24-Hour Economy programme: the 24-Hour Economy Authority Act was assented in February 2026; reported incentives include 25% (two shifts) and 50% (three shifts) corporate tax rebates across eight sub-programmes (Grow24, Make24, Build24, Show24, Connect24, Fund24, Aspire24, Go24). source
- Lower entry barriers under Act 1173: no general minimum capital for foreign-owned firms and JVs outside trading, plus a statutory grievance mechanism and GIPA 24-hour service for registrations, renewals and quota applications. source
- Public infrastructure pipeline: under the 'Big Push', 87 projects had commenced by mid-2026 and US$1.7bn was deposited in a dedicated account for the Accra–Kumasi expressway, creating supply-chain and contracting opportunities. source

### Risks to price in

- Currency risk has returned: after strong appreciation in 2025, the cedi weakened 9.5% year-to-date to GHS 11.55/USD by September 2026, and gross reserves fell from US$14.16bn (March 2026) to US$11.07bn (August 2026). source
- Growth expected to slow: the IMF projects real GDP growth of 4.9% for 2026, below the 6%+ prints of H1 2026; the government's own 2026 floor is 4.8%. source
- Banking vulnerabilities persist in some state-owned banks, some private banks and specialised deposit-taking institutions (IMF). source
- Debt-service and refinancing: S&P kept Ghana at B-/B, noting stronger reserves and exports have not removed constraints from high debt-service costs; government targets a GHS30bn sinking fund by end-2026 for February 2027 domestic debt exchange repayments. source
- Export concentration and price inflation drift: gold accounted for US$14.86bn of US$22.4bn total exports in Jan–Aug 2026, and headline inflation rose from 4.6% (July) to 5.0% (August), with non-food inflation at 6.8%. source

### Who is who in this sector (6)

**Bank of Ghana (BoG)** Central bank; sets the Monetary Policy Rate (14.0%), manages reserves and foreign-exchange regulation; publishes monthly economic and financial data. source

**Ministry of Finance (MoF)** Prepares the annual budget and mid-year review; 2027 Budget expected first week of November 2026; manages the IMF PCI relationship. source

**Ghana Statistical Service (GSS)** Publishes quarterly GDP and monthly CPI; September 2026 CPI scheduled for the second week of October 2026. source

**Ghana Investment Promotion Authority (GIPA, formerly GIPC)** Registers foreign-participation enterprises, administers

Act 1173, the One-Stop-Shop and the Investor Grievance Mechanism. source

**Ghana Free Zones Authority (GFZA)** Licenses export-oriented free zone enterprises and administers free zone tax and duty incentives. source

**International Monetary Fund (IMF)** Completed Ghana's US$3bn ECF on 27 July 2026 with a final SDR 265.9m (~US$371m) disbursement; reviewed a 36-month non-financing Policy Coordination Instrument. source

Watched every week: Bank of Ghana – Summary of Economic and Financial Data (listing page), GSS – Inflation rate highlight, GSS – Release calendar, Ministry of Finance – Press releases, GIPA – News articles, IMF – Ghana country page.




CHAPTER 2

# Gold, mining and critical minerals

*Gold drives two-thirds of Ghana's exports as the state resets royalties, ASM trading and licensing rules*

Gold exports reached USD 14.86bn in January–August 2026 out of USD 22.44bn in total exports (Bank of Ghana), after a record USD 20.98bn in 2025. Output hit a provisional record of about 6 million ounces in 2025, with artisanal and small-scale mining (about 3.1 Moz) overtaking large-scale mines (2.9 Moz), and the Ghana Gold Board (GoldBod) is now the sole buyer and exporter of ASM gold. Since 10 March 2026 a sliding-scale gold royalty of 5% to 12% applies under L.I. 2517, partly offset by a cut in the Growth and Sustainability Levy from 3% to 1% of gross production. Ghana ratified its first lithium mining lease (Ewoyaa) in March 2026, and a revised Minerals and Mining Act that would phase out stability agreements is awaiting Parliament, which makes regulatory change the main thing for investors to watch.

## Key figures

**Gold exports, cumulative**
**14,863.2** USD million
Jan–Aug 2026
Official Bank of Ghana, Summary of Economic and Financial Data, September 2026 (released 23 Sep 2026)

**Total merchandise exports, cumulative**
**22,440.1** USD million
Jan–Aug 2026
Official Bank of Ghana, Summary of Economic and Financial Data, September 2026

**Gold exports, full year**
**20,975.3** USD million
Jan–Dec 2025
Official Bank of Ghana, Summary of Economic and Financial Data, September 2026 (2025:12 column)

**International gold price (BoG reported)**
**4,408.4** USD per fine ounce
Aug 2026 (2026:08 column)
Official Bank of Ghana, Summary of Economic and Financial Data, September 2026

**Total gold production (provisional)**
**6** million ounces
2025
Reported Ghana Chamber of Mines data, reported by Mining Weekly (13 Feb 2026)

**Large-scale mine gold production (provisional)**
**2.9** million ounces
2025
Reported Ghana Chamber of Mines data, reported by Mining Weekly (13 Feb 2026)

**Artisanal and small-scale (ASM) gold production (provisional)**
**3.1** million ounces
2025
Reported Ghana Chamber of Mines data, reported by Mining Weekly (13 Feb 2026)

**GoldBod ASM gold exported**
**104** metric tonnes
generating over USD 10bn
Jan–Dec 2025
Reported Deputy Minister for Finance to Parliament (24 Jun 2026), reported by MyJoyOnline

**GoldBod gold purchase spending**
**16.1** USD billion
of which 9.8 in 2025
Jan 2025–May 2026
Reported Deputy Minister for Finance to Parliament (24 Jun 2026), reported by MyJoyOnline

**GoldBod ASM gold purchases year-to-date**
**50–54** metric tonnes
2026 to mid-July (H1 2026)
Reported GoldBod CEO, reported by Citi Newsroom (15 Jul 2026)

**Newmont Ahafo North expected output**
**275,000–325,000** ounces per year
Next five years from commercial production (announced 24 Oct 2025); 13-year mine life
Official Newmont news release

**Forest reserve area degraded by illegal mining**
**8,923.8** hectares (45 forest reserves and a national park)
As at 31 Dec 2024 (released 24 Feb 2026)
Reported Forestry Commission remote-sensing study, reported by Graphic Online

## Rules that matter

- Royalties: the Minerals and Mining (Royalties) Regulations, 2025 (L.I. 2517), in force since 10 March 2026, replace the flat 5% gold royalty with a price-linked scale. The rate is 5% up to US$1,900/oz and steps up in bands of about US$500/oz to 12% above US$4,500/oz, based on the weekly LBMA London PM average. Small-scale gold pays 2%. Diamonds, bauxite, manganese, iron ore and industrial minerals stay at 5%. At the Bank of Ghana's August 2026 gold price of US$4,408.4/oz, the 11% band (above US$4,000 to US$4,500) applies. source
- Growth and Sustainability Levy: in March 2026 Parliament passed an amendment cutting the levy on mining companies' gross production from 3% to 1%, to offset the new sliding-scale royalties. source
- Mineral rights (Minerals and Mining Act, 2006, Act 703), granted through the Minerals Commission. The reconnaissance licence runs 12 months (up to 5,000 blocks of 21 ha). The prospecting licence runs 3 years (up to 750 blocks). The mining lease runs up to 30 years (up to 300 blocks) and the restricted mining lease up to 15 years for building and industrial minerals. The small-scale mining licence lasts 5 years and is reserved for Ghanaians only. The Government holds a 10% free carried interest in mining operations. source
- Gold trading: under the Ghana Gold Board Act, 2025 (Act 1140), GoldBod has the exclusive right to buy, sell, assay, value and export ASM gold. Foreign nationals had to leave local gold trading by 30 April 2025, and dealing in gold without a GoldBod licence has been an offence since 1 May 2025. Large-scale miners' export arrangements are not covered by these restrictions. From 1 September 2026, Self-Financing Aggregators must refine gold doré at a GoldBod-approved refinery in Ghana before export. source
- Forest reserves: the Environmental Protection (Mining in Forest Reserves) Revocation Instrument, 2025 matured into law on 10 December 2025. It revokes L.I. 2462, which had allowed the

## Opportunities

- Large-scale exploration and mining rights are open to foreign-owned Ghanaian companies through the Minerals Commission's licensing process (reconnaissance, prospecting and mining lease), using the online mining cadastre. Small-scale licences remain reserved for Ghanaians. source
- Lithium: Parliament ratified Atlantic Lithium's Ewoyaa mining lease on 20 March 2026, the first lithium lease granted and ratified in Ghana (initial 15-year term, sliding royalty of 5% to 12%). The project is moving towards a final investment decision, creating openings for offtake, financing, EPC and services. source
- Refining and value addition: GoldBod's mandatory local refining of aggregator doré from 1 September 2026 creates demand for GoldBod-approved refining, assaying and logistics capacity in Ghana. source
- Bauxite and aluminium: GIADEC is seeking partners to build an integrated bauxite–alumina–aluminium value chain on about 920 million tonnes of reserves (Awaso, Nyinahin, Kyebi). It offers resource-for-credit swaps, long-term offtake and joint-venture partnerships. source
- Mining services and supply chain: new large-scale capacity such as Newmont's Ahafo North (commercial production from October 2025, about 560 permanent and 1,000 contracted operating roles) needs contractors and suppliers. Foreign providers typically take part through partnerships that comply with the L.I. 2431 local content rules. source

## Risks to price in

- Fiscal take: the L.I. 2517 royalty reaches 12% above US$4,500/oz. The Ghana Chamber of Mines warned that the increase would hit new projects immediately and put the projected 6.5 Moz output for 2026 at risk. source
- Legal reform: in July 2026 Cabinet approved amendments to the Minerals and Mining Act for Parliament. They would phase out fiscal stability agreements, replace reconnaissance and prospecting licences with a single exploration licence capped at five years, and require community development agreements negotiated with host communities. The final text is pending. source
- Lease renewal risk: the Damang mining lease was not renewed for Gold Fields. Gold Fields exited on 19 April 2026, and the Ministry of Lands and Natural Resources granted the lease to Engineers and Planners after a tender. source
- ESG and illegal mining (galamsey): the Forestry Commission recorded 8,923.8 ha of forest reserves degraded by illegal mining as at end-2024. In February 2026 the government announced a Ghana Armed Forces-led cleanup of water bodies and stronger NAIMOS enforcement. Investors face reputational, community and supply-chain due-diligence exposure. source
- Concentration and price exposure: gold makes up about two-thirds of export earnings and ASM supplies more than half of output. GoldBod based its 2026 forecasts on about US$5,000/oz, above recent prices, so export receipts and state gold purchases are sensitive to the gold price. source


Uffe Carlson, uffe.carlson@gmail.com, +233 55 239 5548 · Joy Preston, joy@gothamconsult.com, +233 55 041 6627

President to authorise mining in forest reserves. source

- Local content and fiscal terms: the Minerals and Mining (Local Content and Local Participation) Regulations, 2020 (L.I. 2431) set local procurement, employment and participation requirements. Corporate income tax on mineral operations is 35%. Under current law, stability agreements can run up to 15 years, and development agreements are available for investments above US$500m. source

### Who is who in this sector (8)

**Minerals Commission** Main regulator for mineral rights. Receives and evaluates licence applications, runs the mining cadastre, inspects mines and makes recommendations to the Minister of Lands and Natural Resources. source

**Newmont** Operates Ahafo South and Ahafo North (commercial production October 2025; 275,000–325,000 oz/yr guided over the next five years). source

**AngloGold Ashanti** Owns 100% of the Obuasi underground mine (Ashanti Region; 266,000 oz in FY25) and also operates Iduapriem. source

**Asante Gold** Listed on TSXV and GSE; operates the Bibiani and Chirano gold mines. 2026 guidance is 275,000–300,000 oz at an AISC of US$3,200–3,600/oz. source

**Ghana Gold Board (GoldBod)** Set up under Act 1140 (2025) as the sole authority to buy, sell, assay, value and export ASM gold and other precious minerals. Licenses gold traders and aggregators and sets refining rules. source

**Gold Fields** Holds 90% of the Tarkwa mine, with the Government of Ghana holding 10%. The mine has a 6.1 Moz reserve and 13.5 Mtpa plant capacity. Gold Fields exited Damang in April 2026. source

**Zijin Mining** Completed its US$1bn acquisition of the Akyem open-pit gold mine from Newmont on 16 April 2025. source

**Atlantic Lithium** Developer of the Ewoyaa lithium project (Central Region), holder of Ghana's first ratified lithium mining lease (20 March 2026). source

Watched every week: Bank of Ghana – Summary of Economic and Financial Data, GoldBod news, Minerals Commission – News & Events, Ghana Chamber of Mines – News updates, Newmont – Operations (Ahafo South/North).


Uffe Carlson, uffe.carlson@gmail.com, +233 55 239 5548 · Joy Preston, joy@gothamconsult.com, +233 55 041 6627



CHAPTER 3

# Oil and gas, power and renewables

*Jubilee drilling reverses a six-year oil decline while power-sector finances improve but remain the main investor risk*

Ghana's crude output fell for a sixth consecutive year in 2025 to 37.3 million barrels, but a 2026 Jubilee infill campaign lifted oil and gas activity by 21.4% in Q2 2026, and oil exports reached US$2.42bn in January–August 2026. Jubilee and TEN licences have been extended to 2040, which brings up to 20 additional Jubilee wells; a further 10-well campaign is signed for 2027–28. The power system has 5,818 MW installed and depends on thermal plants for about three-quarters of generation. The IMF reports the energy-sector shortfall fell to US$1.4bn in 2025, but legacy payables to IPPs and fuel suppliers were still US$1.7bn in March 2026, so offtaker credit risk remains the central issue for power investors.

## Key figures

**Crude oil export earnings (year to date)**
**2,424.9** USD million
January–August 2026 (cumulative)
Official Bank of Ghana, Summary of Economic and Financial Data, September 2026

**Oil and gas sector real growth**
**21.4** % year on year
Q2 2026
Reported Ghana Statistical Service Q2 2026 GDP release, reported by MyJoyOnline

**Total crude oil production (Jubilee, TEN, Sankofa-Gye Nyame)**
**37.3** million barrels
37,302,798 barrels
Calendar year 2025
Official PIAC 2025 Annual Report

**Total petroleum receipts to the state**
**770.27** USD million
Calendar year 2025 (down 43.27% from US$1.36bn in 2024)
Official PIAC 2025 Annual Report

**Jubilee field gross oil production**
**72,000** barrels per day
approximate
Q2 2026 average
Official Kosmos Energy, Second Quarter 2026 Results (3 Aug 2026)

**TEN fields gross oil production**
**14,700** barrels per day
approximate
Q2 2026 average
Official Kosmos Energy, Second Quarter 2026 Results (3 Aug 2026)

**Installed grid generation capacity (dependable: 4,968 MW)**
**5,818** MW
July 2026
Reported PURC Ghana Electricity Supply Fact Sheet, July 2026, reported by MyJoyOnline

**Thermal share of electricity generation**
**74.33** % of total generation
July 2026
Reported PURC Ghana Electricity Supply Fact Sheet, July 2026, reported by MyJoyOnline

**Energy-sector financial shortfall (revenue vs cost gap)**
**1.4** USD billion (1.2% of GDP)
2025 (from US$1.6bn in 2024)
Official IMF Country Report No. 26/212, Ghana Sixth ECF Review / 2026 Article IV

**Net payables owed to IPPs and fuel suppliers**
**1.7** USD billion
End-March 2026 (from US$2.1bn at end-2024)
Reported IMF assessment reported by Ghana News Agency (Aug 2026)

**Electricity tariff adjustment (quarterly mechanism)**
**+3.49** %
Q3 2026); 0 (Q4 2026
Q3 2026 (from 1 July 2026); Q4 2026 (1 Oct–31 Dec 2026)
Official IMF Country Report No. 26/212 (Q3); PURC Q4 decision reported by GNA (24 Sep 2026)

**Share of upstream service contract value awarded to indigenous Ghanaian companies**
**29** %
US$324.1m
Calendar year 2025
Official PIAC 2025 Annual Report

### Rules that matter

- Local content (L.I. 2204, 2013): an indigenous Ghanaian company other than GNPC must hold at least 5% equity for a party to qualify for a petroleum agreement or licence; a foreign company supplying goods or services to the upstream sector must form a joint venture giving an indigenous Ghanaian company at least 10% equity. Operators must also run bidding processes that give preference to indigenous companies. source
- Renewable Energy Act, 2011 (Act 832), s.8: any commercial activity in the renewable energy industry needs an Energy Commission licence. This covers production, transport, storage, distribution, sale, import, export and installation/maintenance. source
- Act 832 as amended by Act 1045 (2020), s.25: grid-connected renewable power must go through a competitive procurement scheme (tender or auction). Public utilities may not negotiate PPAs unless the power has gone through an open, competitive and transparent procurement process. source
- Net metering (Act 832 s.30A, inserted 2020): a statutory net-metering scheme for renewable self-generation. Under s.26, distribution utilities must procure renewable electricity from consumer-generators. source
- PURC resets electricity and water tariffs every quarter. It indexes them to the cedi–dollar rate, inflation, the weighted average cost of gas (US$7.9708/MMBtu used for Q4 2026) and the generation mix. For Q4 2026 (1 Oct–31 Dec) the change is 0%. source
- Energy Commission standards and labelling regulations (in force; moratorium ended Nov 2023) cover imports of solar panels (L.I. 2449), renewable-energy batteries (L.I. 2452) and inverters (L.I. 2461). Importers must meet registration and labelling requirements. source

### Opportunities

- Upstream services and drilling supply chain. Six Jubilee producers and one injector came onstream in H1 2026. A 2027–28 Ghana campaign of up to 10 wells is signed, with the rig expected around mid-2027. The Jubilee and TEN licence extensions to 2040 allow up to 20 additional Jubilee wells. Service firms must meet the 10% indigenous joint-venture rule. source
- Gas supply and processing. GRIDCo's 2025 Electricity Supply Plan put firm Jubilee/TEN/OCTP supply at about 416 mmscf/d. It also identified a need for additional gas volumes to meet thermal demand. Eni says OCTP meets about 70% of gas demand for power generation, and Eban-Akoma (declared commercial July 2025) is set to become a new source of supply. source
- Utility-scale solar plus storage for industry. The 24-Hour Economy Secretariat is co-developing up to 1.5 GW of solar with battery storage at Buipe. The joint development agreement was signed on 10 April 2026, and construction of the first 100 MW was announced for August 2026. The target is to cut industrial power costs from 18–23 to 7–9 US cents/kWh. source
- Commercial and industrial (C&I) and rooftop solar under net metering. Grid supply is about 74% thermal, and the law provides a net-metering scheme and a renewable purchase obligation on distribution utilities. Together these support behind-the-meter solar for factories, mines and commercial property. source
- Distribution private-sector participation. The IMF reports that a transaction adviser has been appointed to procure ECG concessionaires, with concessions expected to be awarded by June 2027. This is an entry point for distribution operators, metering and loss-reduction contractors. source

### Risks to price in

- Offtaker payment risk. Net payables to IPPs and fuel suppliers were still US$1.7bn at end-March 2026. The IMF projects a sector shortfall of about US$1.1bn in 2026, driven by collection and distribution losses, and warns the sector is prone to slippages during electoral periods. source
- Reserve decline. Ghana's crude output fell for the sixth consecutive year in 2025, down 22.7% to 37.3m barrels. Production gains depend on continued infill drilling in mature fields. source
- Fiscal and tax disputes. On 30 September 2026 an ICC tribunal found that a US$196.5m corporate income tax assessment on Tullow was not in breach of its petroleum agreements. Investors should model the risk of tax claims under stability clauses. source
- Currency and tariff risk. Revenue is in cedis while gas and many IPP contracts are priced in dollars. PURC tariffs move quarterly with FX and gas costs (Q2 2026: -4.81%; Q3: +3.49%; Q4: 0%), so cedi depreciation or a tariff freeze compresses cost recovery. source
- Thermal and gas dependence. Thermal plants supplied 74.33% of generation in July 2026, and PURC's Q4 2026 tariff assumed a mix that is 79.10% thermal. Supply depends on domestic gas availability and pricing, which exposes generators and offtakers to field outages and gas cost changes. source

### Who is who in this sector (8)

**Ghana National Petroleum Corporation (GNPC)** National oil company and carried-interest partner in all fields. Reports

**Petroleum Commission** Upstream regulator responsible for licensing, permits and local content (L.I. 2204). Promoting new


Uffe Carlson, uffe.carlson@gmail.com, +233 55 239 5548 · Joy Preston, joy@gothamconsult.com, +233 55 041 6627

Jubilee above 80,000 bopd (Sept 2026) and about US$3.5bn of partner upstream investment commitments. source

**Tullow Oil** Operator of Jubilee and TEN. Working-interest output was 43.7 kboepd in H1 2026, and it has recovered its historic Ghana gas receivables. source

**Eni (OCTP / Sankofa-Gye Nyame, with Vitol and GNPC)** Operator of OCTP, which supplies about 70% of Ghana's gas demand for power generation. Developing the Eban-Akoma discovery. source

**Electricity Company of Ghana (ECG)** Main distribution utility and power offtaker, and the main source of sector losses. Concessions for private participation are expected to be awarded by June 2027. source

investment, including the South Deep Water Tano negotiations. source

**Kosmos Energy** Jubilee and TEN partner. Its licences were extended to 2040 (ratified February 2026), with up to US$2bn of incremental investment. source

**Public Utilities Regulatory Commission (PURC)** Sets electricity and water tariffs through quarterly adjustments and publishes monthly electricity supply fact sheets. source

**Energy Commission** Licenses renewable-energy and electricity businesses, enforces equipment standards, and is leading validation of the 2026 Integrated Power System Master Plan. source

Watched every week: Bank of Ghana – Summary of Economic and Financial Data, PURC – tariff announcements and electricity supply fact sheets, Petroleum Commission newsroom, PIAC reports, Tullow Oil press releases, Kosmos Energy investor news.


Uffe Carlson, uffe.carlson@gmail.com, +233 55 239 5548 · Joy Preston, joy@gothamconsult.com, +233 55 041 6627



CHAPTER 4

# Cocoa, agribusiness and agro-processing

*Cocoa earnings rise and financing is moving onshore, as a 50% local-processing mandate begins with the 2026/27 season*

Bank of Ghana data show cocoa exports of USD 2.76bn for January–August 2026, up from USD 2.47bn a year earlier, although gold still accounts for most export earnings. COCOBOD has replaced its decades-old offshore syndicated loan with a GH¢16.3bn domestic notes programme run by its subsidiary Cocoa Capital PLC, and opened the 2026/27 season at GH¢42,400 per tonne (71.18% of realised gross FOB, above the 70% floor in the new Ghana Cocoa Board Act, 2026). From 2026/27, Cabinet policy requires at least half of the cocoa crop to be processed locally, while the 13 existing grinders run at only 30–40% of about 500,000 tonnes of installed capacity. Beyond cocoa, the investment case rests on import substitution (2025 food imports were above GH¢36.5bn), cashew and shea processing, and cold chain. Swollen shoot disease, illegal mining, smuggling, EUDR compliance from 30 December 2026 and cedi volatility are the main risks.

## Key figures

**Cocoa export earnings, cumulative**

**2,762.4** USD million

Jan–Aug 2025: 2,467.3

Jan–Aug 2026

Official Bank of Ghana, Summary of Economic and Financial Data, September 2026

**Cocoa export earnings, first half**

**2,300.0** USD million

H1 2025: 2,167.5

Jan–Jun 2026

Official Bank of Ghana, Summary of Economic and Financial Data, September 2026

**Cocoa export earnings, full year**

**4,000.8** USD million

Jan–Dec 2025

Official Bank of Ghana, Summary of Economic and Financial Data, September 2026

**Cocoa producer price (GH¢2,650 per 64kg bag; 71.18% of realised gross FOB)**

**42,400** GH¢ per tonne

2025/26: 41,392

2026/27 season, effective 25 Sep 2026

Reported Ghana News Agency, reporting COCOBOD announcement

**Cocoa Capital PLC domestic financing programme (GH¢14bn commercial paper + GH¢2.3bn bonds)**

**16.3** GH¢ billion

2026/27 season (announced Sep 2026)

Reported Ghana News Agency

**COCOBOD cocoa purchases (calendar year)**

**597,377** tonnes

2024: 448,969

2025

Reported MyJoyOnline, reporting COCOBOD 2025 financial statements

**COCOBOD net profit (2024: loss of GH¢5.73bn)**

**5.11** GH¢ billion

FY2025

Reported MyJoyOnline, reporting COCOBOD 2025 financial statements

**Agriculture real GDP growth, year on year (crops +5.2%, livestock +5.9%, fishing -24.7%)**

**3.9** %

Q2 2025: 7.1

Q2 2026

Reported Ghana News Agency, reporting Ghana Statistical Service quarterly GDP

**Combined installed cocoa processing capacity (13 companies, running at 30–40% utilisation)**

**500,000** tonnes per year

May 2026

Reported Graphic Online, reporting the Cocoa Marketing Company MD


Uffe Carlson, uffe.carlson@gmail.com, +233 55 239 5548 · Joy Preston, joy@gothamconsult.com, +233 55 041 6627

**Cashew export revenue (42% of USD 710.3m non-traditional agricultural exports; shea nuts USD 177.79m)**

**297.59** USD million

2025

**Reported** Ecofin Agency, citing Ghana Export Promotion Authority

**Cocoa products (butter, cake) within non-traditional exports; total NTEs passed USD 5bn**

**>800** USD million

2025

**Reported** Ghana News Agency, citing Ghana Export Promotion Authority

**Food import bill (largest items: processed cereals, frozen chicken, rice)**

**>36.5** GH¢ billion

2025

**Reported** Graphic Online, reporting GSS Annual International Merchandise Trade Statistics

## Rules that matter

- The Ghana Cocoa Board Act, 2026 (Act 1182) requires farmers to receive at least 70% of the realised gross FOB price. Haulier, buying-margin, warehousing and inspection rates for 2026/27 are unchanged. source
- In February 2026 Cabinet approved a directive requiring at least 50% of Ghana's cocoa beans to be processed locally, starting with the 2026/27 crop season. source
- Non-citizens may hold land only as leasehold, for no more than 50 years at any one time (Land Act 2020, Act 1036, s.10). Any grant of freehold to a non-citizen is void. Leases are renewable and can be mortgaged. source
- Free zone enterprises pay no income tax for 10 years (confirm the rate that applies afterwards with GFZA and GRA, as it has changed). Imports for production are duty-free and dividends are exempt from withholding tax. At least 70% of output must be exported, so up to 30% may be sold locally. source
- Outside free zones, agro-processors get a 5-year tax holiday. After that, location-based rates apply: 5% in the Northern, Upper East and Upper West Regions, 10% outside regional capitals, 15% in other regional capitals and 20% in Accra/Tema. Tree-crop farming gets a 10-year holiday, and exporters of non-traditional agricultural products pay a concessionary 8% rate. source
- The Ghana Investment Promotion Authority Act, 2026 (Act 1173, assented 15 July 2026) replaces Act 865. It removes blanket minimum capital requirements for wholly foreign-owned enterprises and joint ventures, keeping thresholds only for trading. It also adds a one-stop shop and an investor grievance mechanism. source

## Opportunities

- Cocoa grinding and semi-finished products. The 13 local processors run at only 30–40% of about 500,000 t of installed capacity, and the 50% local-processing mandate from 2026/27 is meant to direct more beans to local grinders. This creates openings for capacity revival, working-capital finance and offtake. source
- Domestic cocoa paper. COCOBOD's new commercial-paper model (three tranches covering an 8-month season, with escrow over cocoa sale proceeds) is open to pension funds and non-resident investors. Cocoa Capital PLC's GH¢16.3bn programme is repaid from assigned forward-sales receivables. source
- Import substitution in rice and poultry. The 2025 food import bill was above GH¢36.5bn. The Feed Ghana coordinator reports rice sufficiency up from 42% to 56% and poultry from 5% to 21%, which still leaves a large gap for integrated poultry, feed and rice-milling investment. source
- Cashew and shea processing. A Nitidae/ACPG study found about 6% of cashew output is processed locally, and the government has announced a phased ban on raw shea-nut exports. Both point to supply for local processors, and GEPA reports shea-nut exports more than doubled to USD 177.79m in 2025. source
- Cold chain and processed food for AfCFTA markets. US Commerce puts cold-chain revenue potential in fruit and vegetables at up to USD 900m a year, largely untapped. Government is repositioning special economic zones around agro-processing and offering rules-of-origin support for AfCFTA trade, with the AfCFTA Secretariat based in Accra. source

## Risks to price in

- Cocoa swollen shoot virus disease. In February 2024 COCOBOD's then chief executive said more than 500,000 hectares of cocoa farms had been lost to it. This constrains bean supply for processors and the long-term outlook for output. source
- Illegal mining (galamsey) on farmland. COCOBOD reported more than 19,000 ha of cocoa farms destroyed or affected, concentrated in the Eastern, Western and Ashanti regions, which produce over 90% of the crop. This is the latest official figure found and dates from 2022. source
- Smuggling. A COCOBOD official estimated losses of almost USD 1.1bn to cocoa smuggling into Togo and Côte d'Ivoire over 2022–2025. Recorded output in Volta/Oti collapsed from 7,215 t (2020/21) to 87 t (2024/25). source
- EU Deforestation Regulation compliance. EUDR applies to cocoa exports from 30 December 2026, so traceability and geolocation gaps could disrupt shipments to the EU. source
- FX and financing. The cedi depreciated 7.1% against the USD year-to-date to August 2026 (BoG). Crop finance now depends on domestic money-market appetite for COCOBOD paper rather than offshore syndicated loans. source

### Who is who in this sector (8)

**Ghana Cocoa Board (COCOBOD)** State regulator and sole marketer of cocoa. It sets the producer price (GH¢42,400/t for 2026/27) and leads disease control and EUDR readiness. source

**Cocoa Capital PLC** Wholly owned COCOBOD subsidiary issuing the GH¢16.3bn Domestic Cocoa Notes Programme. Bookrunners are Absa, CalBank, Fincap, GCB, One Africa Securities and Stanbic. source

**Cocoa Marketing Company (CMC)** COCOBOD's marketing arm, which handles forward sales and is tasked with supporting greater use of local processing capacity. source

**Cocoa Processing Company (CPC)** Listed state-linked chocolate and semi-finished cocoa producer. It plans to more than double output with new machinery. source

**Ghana Export Promotion Authority (GEPA)** Export promotion agency. It reports non-traditional exports above USD 5bn in 2025, targets USD 10bn by 2030 and runs the Accelerated Export Development Programme. source

**Ghana Free Zones Authority (GFZA)** Licenses export-oriented free zone enterprises, including agro-processors, under the 10-year tax holiday regime. source

**Ghana Investment Promotion Authority (GIPA)** Investment registration and promotion body under Act 1173 (2026). It runs the one-stop shop and the investor grievance mechanism. source

**Feed Ghana Programme (Ministry of Food and Agriculture)** Flagship food-security programme launched April 2025, covering the Nkoko Nkitinkiti poultry scheme, inputs and irrigation. Its second phase from October 2026 focuses on value-chain linkages. source

Watched every week: Bank of Ghana – Summary of Economic and Financial Data, COCOBOD news, Ghana Statistical Service – release calendar, Ghana Free Zones Authority, Ghana News Agency.


Uffe Carlson, uffe.carlson@gmail.com, +233 55 239 5548 · Joy Preston, joy@gothamconsult.com, +233 55 041 6627



CHAPTER 5

# ICT and fintech, manufacturing, real estate and logistics

*ICT is Ghana's fastest-growing sector and mobile money exceeds GH¢500bn a month, while ports run near capacity and industrial policy has moved from 1D1F to the 24-Hour Economy (24H+) framework*

Ghana's Statistical Service reported ICT growth of 30.9% year-on-year in Q2 2026, the main driver of 6.0% real GDP growth, and Bank of Ghana data show monthly mobile money transactions of GH¢518.8bn in August 2026. The new Ghana Investment Promotion Authority Act, 2026 (Act 1173) removes blanket minimum capital for non-trading foreign enterprises, and the 24-Hour Economy Authority Act (assented February 2026) is the new channel for manufacturing incentives after the One District One Factory programme was discontinued in 2025. Housing remains structurally short (deficit estimated at over 1.8 million units), with non-citizens limited to 50-year renewable leaseholds. Container traffic through Tema and Takoradi rose 12.2% in January–May 2026, but congestion at Tema and slow delivery of inland port and rail projects are binding constraints.

## Key figures

**ICT (information & communication) real growth**

**30.9** % y/y

Q2 2026

Reported Ghana News Agency, reporting GSS Q2 2026 GDP release (9 Sep 2026)

**Manufacturing sub-sector growth**

**6.6** % y/y

Q2 2026 (vs 5.4% Q2 2025)

Reported Ghana News Agency, reporting GSS Q2 2026 GDP release

**Construction growth**

**4.4** % y/y

Q2 2026 (vs 6.5% Q2 2025)

Reported Ghana News Agency, reporting GSS Q2 2026 GDP release

**Mobile money (e-money) transaction value (volume: 1,046 million transactions)**

**518.8** GH¢ billion per month

August 2026

Official Bank of Ghana, Summary of Economic and Financial Charts, September 2026

**Active e-money customers (registered: 85.8 million)**

**26.4** million

August 2026

Official Bank of Ghana, FinTech Statistics

**Mobile money transaction value, full year**

**4.54** GH¢ trillion (+50.8% y/y)

2025

Reported MyJoyOnline, citing Bank of Ghana (24 Sep 2026)

**Mobile voice subscriptions (penetration 128.26%)**

**43.50** million

Q1 2026 (end-March)

Official National Communications Authority, Q1 2026 Statistical Bulletin

**Total data subscriptions (penetration 90.17%)**

**30.73** million

June 2026

Official National Communications Authority, Monthly Industry Data June 2026

**Housing deficit**

**>1.8** million units

Estimate stated 28 Jan 2026

Reported 3News, quoting the Minister for Works and Housing

**Container traffic, Tema and Takoradi (laden, inbound + outbound)**

**394,742** containers (+12.2% y/y)

January–May 2026

Official Bank of Ghana, Monetary Policy Report July 2026

**National container throughput (Tema 1,668,688 TEU; Takoradi 32,558 TEU)**

**1,701,246** TEU (projected)

2024

Reported Citi Newsroom, reporting GPHA statistics (30 Sep 2025)

**MPS Terminal 3 (Tema) annual handling capacity after equipment upgrade**

**2.5 → 3.0** million TEU

Announced March 2026

Reported Meridian Port Services

**Boankra Integrated Logistics Terminal progress vs. target**

**6 vs 20** % complete (US$308m project)

April 2026

Reported News Ghana (24 Apr 2026)


Uffe Carlson, uffe.carlson@gmail.com, +233 55 239 5548 · Joy Preston, joy@gothamconsult.com, +233 55 041 6627

## Rules that matter

- Ghana Investment Promotion Authority Act, 2026 (Act 1173), assented 15 July 2026, repeals the GIPC Act 2013 (Act 865). Blanket minimum capital for wholly foreign-owned and joint-venture enterprises is removed; foreign trading enterprises need US$500,000 cash equity and at least 75% skilled Ghanaian staff; expatriate quota of 2–12 staff scales with invested capital (US$50,000 to >US$10m); GIPA registration must be renewed annually. source
- Bank of Ghana licenses non-bank payments under seven categories: Dedicated Electronic Money Issuer, PSP Scheme, PSP-Enhanced, PSP-Medium, PSP-Standard (reserved for Ghanaians and wholly Ghanaian-owned entities), Payment and Financial Technology Service Provider, and Digital Credit Services Provider. Applications go through the BoG FinTech & Innovation Office; a regulatory sandbox admitted six firms for one year in January 2026 to test virtual-asset products. source
- Data Protection Act, 2012 (Act 843): all data controllers and processors must register with the Data Protection Commission. source
- Free Zones Act, 1995 (Act 504): free-zone enterprises must export at least 70% of annual output (up to 30% may be sold locally), receive a 10-year corporate income tax holiday, exemption from import duties on production inputs and from dividend withholding tax, and may be 100% foreign-owned. Sources disagree on the tax rate after the holiday, so confirm it with GFZA and GRA before modelling. source
- Land Act, 2020 (Act 1036), s.10(6), and Article 266 of the Constitution: no leasehold exceeding 50 years at any one time may be granted to a non-citizen. The lease is renewable; freehold is not available to non-citizens. source
- Real Estate Agency Act, 2020 (Act 1047): agents, brokers and persons developing, managing or marketing property for sale or rent must be licensed by the Real Estate Agency Council, which also monitors anti-money-laundering risk in property transactions. source

## Opportunities

- Payments and embedded finance: mobile money reached GH¢518.8bn and 1.05bn transactions in August 2026, but only about 26.4m of 85.8m registered accounts are active. This leaves room for merchant acquiring, cross-border remittance, credit and B2B payment products under PSP-Enhanced or PFTSP licences. source
- Fixed broadband and data infrastructure: mobile data penetration is 87.65%, but fibre broadband had only 273,095 subscriptions and Starlink 28,612 in Q1 2026. This points to underbuilt fixed, enterprise-connectivity and hosting capacity behind 30.9% ICT growth. source
- Tech talent and offshore delivery: the government's One Million Coders Programme, rolled out nationally in April 2026, targets 300,000 trainees in 2026 across 130 learning centres. It is a pipeline for software, AI and cybersecurity operations. source
- Export manufacturing and agro-processing: multi-shift plants can combine 24H+ CIT reductions, duty-free equipment and the G-LVAR rebate. Free-zone status (100% foreign ownership, 10-year tax holiday) and lower GIPA entry thresholds suit export-oriented, AfCFTA-facing production; 50 states had ratified AfCFTA by October 2025. source
- Housing and building materials: a deficit officially estimated at over 1.8 million units, urbanisation above 50% and stalled affordable-housing schemes create demand for mid-market housing delivery, rental platforms, construction finance and local materials. Non-citizens are limited to 50-year renewable leases. source
- Port-centric logistics: container traffic is growing at double digits and Tema is congested, while the US$308m Boankra inland terminal is behind schedule and seeking funding. Opportunities include off-dock container yards, bonded warehousing, inland logistics and transit corridors to Burkina Faso, Mali and Niger. source

## Risks to price in

- Port congestion: in September 2026 the Transport Minister ordered urgent action at Tema after container volumes 'increased almost to 100 per cent' and system outages at the MPS terminal. Expect demurrage, delays and off-dock diversion during peak season. source
- Infrastructure delivery: the Boankra inland terminal was 6% complete against a 20% target in April 2026. The Tema–Mpakadan railway needed a US$21m EU grant (July 2026) to fix incomplete signalling and other systems after commissioning. Do not base logistics plans on rail or inland-port capacity yet. source
- Industrial policy discontinuity: the Trade Minister told Parliament in July 2025 that 'there is no policy as 1D1F' and that its incentives had lapsed, leaving many factories idle. Incentives under the successor 24H+ programme depend on the new Authority and enabling tax measures. source
- Free-zone tax erosion: EY reports that the reduced post-holiday rate was repealed and domestic sales are taxed at the standard 25% CIT, while Official sources disagree on the rate after the holiday, so confirm it with GRA before modelling. source
- Telecom market concentration: MTN Ghana holds 80.10% of mobile data subscriptions (June 2026) and about 72% of voice. Pricing, interconnection and significant-market-power rules can change quickly for entrants and partners. source
- Regulatory and ownership limits in fintech and land: PSP-Standard licences are reserved for Ghanaians; all data controllers must register with the DPC; non-citizens cannot hold land leases above 50 years at a time. Title diligence through the Lands Commission is essential. source


Uffe Carlson, uffe.carlson@gmail.com, +233 55 239 5548 · Joy Preston, joy@gothamconsult.com, +233 55 041 6627

- 24-Hour Economy Authority Act (assented 19 Feb 2026) creates the authority that coordinates 24H+ incentives. The published package includes import-tax exemptions on machinery and inputs, CIT reductions for two- and three-shift operations, priority power and water access for 24-hour operators, and a local value-addition rebate (G-LVAR). The government has announced duty- and tax-free import of expansion and retooling equipment for factories registered under the initiative. source
- The Electronic Transfer Levy (E-Levy, 1%) on mobile money and electronic transfers was abolished by the Electronic Transfer Levy Repeal Bill 2025, approved by Parliament on 26 March 2025. source

### Who is who in this sector (8)

**Bank of Ghana – FinTech & Innovation Office** Licenses and supervises e-money issuers, PSPs and digital credit providers; runs the regulatory sandbox and publishes monthly e-money statistics source

**Telecel Ghana / AT Ghana** Second and third mobile operators (20.99% and 7.16% of voice subscriptions, Q1 2026), each with licensed mobile-money affiliates source

**Ghana Investment Promotion Authority (GIPA)** Successor to GIPC under Act 1173; registers foreign-participation enterprises, runs the one-stop shop and investor grievance mechanism source

**Ghana Free Zones Authority** Licenses free-zone enterprises and runs the Tema Export Processing Zone, with offices in Tema, Takoradi and Kumasi source

**MTN Ghana / MobileMoney Ltd** Dominant mobile operator (80.10% of mobile data subscriptions, June 2026); MobileMoney Ltd is a BoG-licensed Dedicated Electronic Money Issuer source

**Hubtel, Paystack Ghana, Flutterwave, eTranzact, Cellulant** Examples of BoG-approved PSP-Enhanced licensees in merchant acquiring, gateways and payment processing source

**24-Hour Economy Authority (24H+)** Statutory body (Feb 2026) coordinating multi-shift incentives, energy, logistics and regulatory facilitation source

**Ghana Ports and Harbours Authority / Meridian Port Services** GPHA owns and regulates the Tema and Takoradi ports (plus the Boankra and Keta projects); MPS operates Tema Terminal 3 and is expanding capacity to 3.0m TEU source

Watched every week: Bank of Ghana – FinTech statistics (monthly e-money data), Ghana Statistical Service – homepage / release calendar, National Communications Authority – reports & statistical bulletins, Ghana Ports and Harbours Authority – news, 24-Hour Economy Secretariat / Authority, Ghana Investment Promotion Authority.

DATES TO WATCH

# What could move the numbers next

**Mid-October 2026**
September inflation (Ghana Statistical Service)

**Early November 2026**
2027 Budget Statement (Ministry of Finance)

**November 2026**
Bank of Ghana Monetary Policy Committee decision

**December 2026**
Q3 2026 GDP (Ghana Statistical Service)

**Late December 2026**
Electricity tariffs for Q1 2027 (PURC)

**30 December 2026**
EU Deforestation Regulation applies to cocoa exports


Uffe Carlson, uffe.carlson@gmail.com, +233 55 239 5548 · Joy Preston, joy@gothamconsult.com, +233 55 041 6627

HOW THIS REPORT STAYS CURRENT

# Checked every week, confirmed by a person

### Live economic data

Growth, inflation, the policy rate and exports update by themselves when the Bank of Ghana and the Ghana Statistical Service publish new figures.

### Every source re-opened weekly

Each week our system opens every source behind every figure and the regulators' newsrooms. If a source changes or something new is published, our team is told.

### A person approves changes

Nothing in the text changes by itself. An analyst reads the new information and updates the report, and every update is listed below with its date.

## Latest updates

The first edition was published on 7 October 2026.

AUTHORS AND CONTACT

# Talk to the people behind this report

Questions about a figure, a sector or investing in Ghana? Write or call us directly. Gotham Consult, Accra, info@gothamconsult.com.

**Uffe Carlson**
Partner, Gotham Consult

uffe.carlson@gmail.com

+233 55 239 5548 · WhatsApp

**Joy Preston**
Managing Partner, Gotham Consult

joy@gothamconsult.com

+233 55 041 6627 · WhatsApp

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